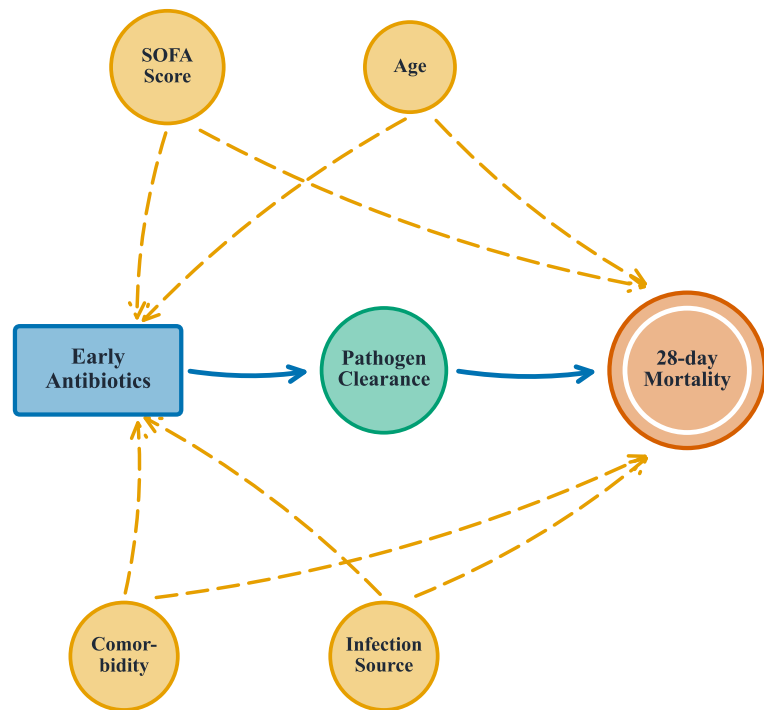
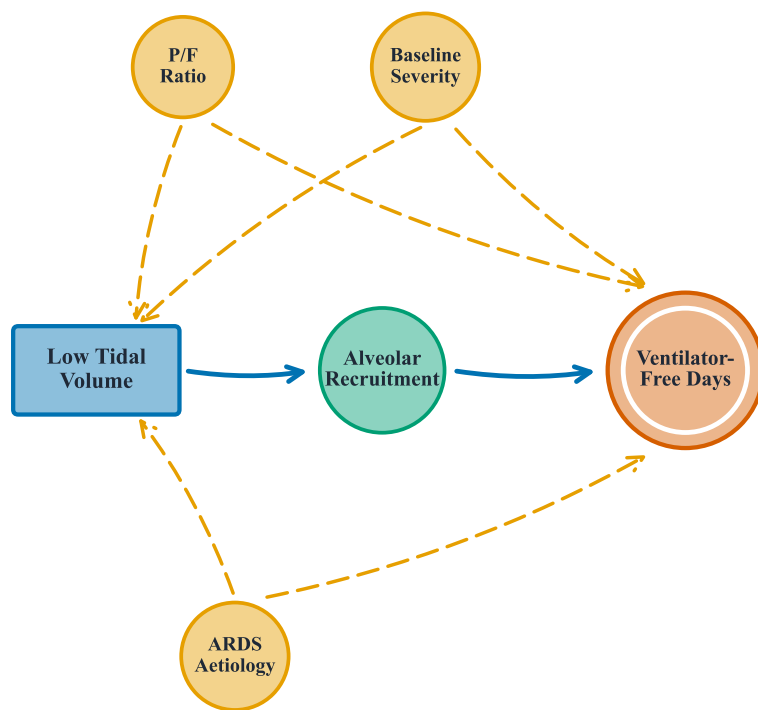


Causal Directed Acyclic Graphs (DAGs) for Three Critical Care Treatment Pathways

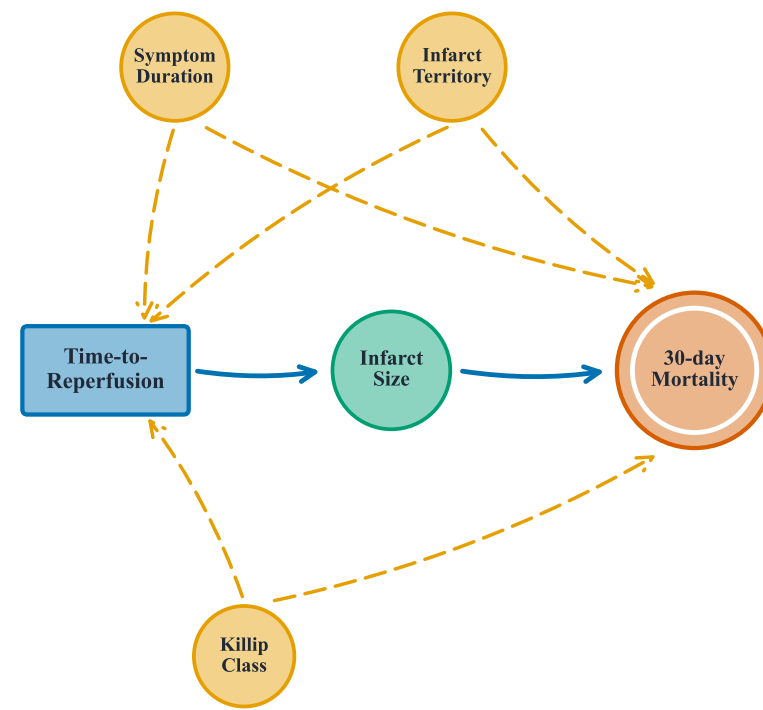
(A) Sepsis: Antibiotic Timing



(B) ARDS: Ventilation Strategy



(C) ACS: Reperfusion Timing



$T = \text{Early Antibiotics } (<3 \text{ h}) \mid Y = \text{28-day Mortality}$ $T = \text{Low Tidal Volume } (6 \text{ mL/kg}) \mid Y = \text{Ventilator-Free Days}$ $T = \text{Door-to-Balloon } (<90 \text{ min}) \mid Y = \text{30-day MACE}$
Treatment (T) — rectangle Outcome (Y) — double circle Confounder (Z) — circle Mediator (M) — circle Causal path — solid blue arrow Backdoor (confounding) path — dashed orange arrow